SYNTHETIC COURT DOCUMENT — FICTIONAL CASE — NOT AN ACTUAL FILING

Occlusion and Field-of-View Annotated Frame Analysis

Prepared for: fictional summary-judgment opposition **Filed:** December 12, 2025 **Sources examined:** certified Rusk and Vega camera working copies, time map, transcript, and breezeway measurements

This authored technical analysis asks a narrow question: what can the two camera views reliably show during the pivotal interval? It does not decide credibility, police reasonableness, medical causation, or law. It uses ordinary frame inspection and geometry; no missing image was synthesized, interpolated, or reconstructed.

The reference clock fixes Rusk's wrist grasp at 19:53:02. His image becomes materially obstructed at 19:53:08 and clears at 19:53:22. During those fourteen seconds, the parties dispute whether Ellison struck Rusk's forearm and reached toward his duty belt or instead recoiled and pulled from a painful grip without threat. The analysis concludes that neither camera provides a reliable continuous view of the relevant hands.

"Not reliably visible" means a reasonable analyst cannot identify the hand's location and contact from recorded pixels at the stated moment. It does not mean the disputed act did or did not occur. Audio is referenced only to align time. Words and sounds cannot substitute for absent visual geometry.

The people, site, recordings, and analysis are fictional. Real technical concepts are used only to make the exercise internally testable.

Camera placement and breezeway geometry

Rusk’s camera was centered on his outer uniform at upper-torso height. Its field followed his chest rather than his gaze. At conversational distance, it captured Ellison’s seated body and both hands. Once Rusk extended his arm and stepped close, his sleeve and forearm occupied the center and lower field. Ellison’s coat added a dark overlapping surface. A vertical building support and metal rail narrowed the right side.

Vega’s camera was also torso mounted. She approached from behind and left of Rusk. Before contact, her more distant view included Rusk, Ellison, and the breezeway opening. As she moved in, Rusk’s back and shoulder lay between her lens and Ellison’s near-side hands. The support and rail affected the remaining angle. Her human sightline changed with head movement, but the recording preserves only the torso direction.

Measurements in the synthetic site note place the clear walkway between wall and inner rail at roughly five feet. That width permits passage but makes three-person close contact visually congested. The analysis does not claim survey-grade precision. A difference of several inches would not restore a hand view behind an intervening torso.

Body-worn cameras are useful contemporaneous sources, but they are not eye trackers and cannot record through opaque clothing or bodies. These limitations existed before any party selected frames for litigation.

Pre-obstruction visibility baseline

At 19:52:48, Rusk’s view clearly shows Ellison seated with both hands empty. Vega’s more distant frames are consistent with that observation. The phone and keys lie near the wall. No visible weapon is present. This baseline establishes initial conditions, not the state of every later second.

At 19:53:02, Rusk’s hand visibly closes around Ellison’s left wrist. The seizure begins at a moment captured from his own device. At 19:53:03 through 19:53:05, Ellison turns and the restrained arm moves toward her torso. The free hand is visible only intermittently as Rusk’s arm expands across the frame.

By 19:53:07, the bodies occupy most of Rusk’s image. Vega has begun moving closer, but her line passes behind Rusk. A viewer can see rotation and closing distance. A viewer cannot determine from those last relatively clear frames what Ellison’s free hand does several seconds later.

The baseline matters for two reasons. First, it refutes any claim that the recording begins with a visible weapon. Second, it prevents an opposite overstatement: initially empty hands do not make a later reach physically impossible. Both parties’ narratives remain possible at the moment obstruction starts. The analysis therefore marks the transition without assigning the disputed motion to either account.

Rusk-camera occlusion from 19:53:08 to 19:53:15

At 19:53:08, opaque regions from Rusk’s sleeve and Ellison’s coat cover the central interaction. The support and rail take additional space. Successive frames show fabric translation, partial concrete, and blurred edges, but no stable hand contour. The obstruction is material, not a brief single-frame blink.

At 19:53:11, the audible exchange “stop pulling” and “you’re hurting me” occurs while the hands remain hidden. Those words are compatible with the existence of pulling and pain. They do not specify whether the free hand struck a forearm or approached equipment. The frame cannot attach the speakers’ phrases to a visible contact.

A dull sound near 19:53:12 lacks a visible source. Spectral or volume description cannot uniquely identify a hand strike, body collision, shoe impact, or contact with the rail. The analysis therefore labels it “unresolved contact sound,” not “blow.”

At 19:53:14 and 19:53:15, camera pitch changes, but the occluding surfaces remain. Rusk’s phrase “stay off it” has no visible referent. Treating “it” as the duty belt would adopt his interpretation; treating it as meaningless would ignore context. The technical finding is only that image data cannot resolve the referent.

Device cycle, descent, and continuing obstruction

The energy-device sound begins at approximately 19:53:16 and ends near 19:53:21. The activation log separately reports one five-second cycle. During those seconds Rusk's camera rotates toward the floor. Parts of the wall, rail, clothing, and concrete become visible in changing proportions, but the critical hands and device contact geometry do not become reliably identifiable.

The image supports the conclusion that Ellison descends while the cycle is active. It does not reveal whether a forearm strike or belt reach preceded activation. Nor can it isolate the relative contribution of Rusk's downward force, Ellison's balance, her pulling, or the electrical exposure to each frame's movement. A motion path is not itself a motive or threat classification.

At 19:53:20, Vega begins entering the edge of Rusk's frame. Her appearance confirms approach timing, not what she saw. The electrical sound ends at 19:53:21. At 19:53:22, the view clears with Ellison down and Vega moving to control a hand.

The first post-obstruction image is not a photograph of the preceding event. Reverse inference from "down afterward" to "threatening before" is unwarranted, as is reverse inference to "entirely passive before." The missing visual interval must remain missing unless other admissible evidence supplies facts under an applicable standard.

Vega-camera comparison

Vega's recording supplies a broader early view but not a reliable answer about the critical hands. When contact begins, Rusk's torso blocks the center while Vega's forward movement adds frame shift. From 19:53:08 through the device cycle, Ellison's free hand cannot be tracked consistently. A light region appears intermittently, but it cannot be assigned to a particular hand or contact surface. Contrast adjustment cannot recover detail that an opaque body prevented the sensor from receiving.

After 19:53:22, Vega's angle improves as she takes hand control. Those frames corroborate restraint completion, not earlier placement. Synchronizing two blocked views cannot create an imaginary third viewpoint.

Common radio cues and event markers align the camera clocks. Residual subsecond uncertainty does not alter the fixed sequence: obstruction begins at 19:53:08, one cycle runs approximately 19:53:16–19:53:21, and the view clears at 19:53:22. Audio establishes commands, Ellison's pain report and cry, movement noise, a contact sound, the continuous cycle, and Vega's approach. No sound uniquely identifies hand position.

No discontinuity, mute segment, duplicate time, or manual cut was found. Continuity authenticates the limitation rather than curing it: the image is blocked, not deleted. The exhibit does not label either speaker's tone or fill uncertainty with assumptions. A procedural rule may require plaintiff-favorable facts, but that legal choice cannot turn hidden pixels into visible proof.

Findings and declaration

The analysis reaches six bounded findings. First, both recordings show initially empty hands. Second, Rusk’s recording shows the wrist restraint beginning at 19:53:02. Third, his material visual obstruction lasts exactly from 19:53:08 through 19:53:22. Fourth, Vega’s angle does not reliably show the relevant hands during that same critical interaction. Fifth, audio and the device log establish one cycle’s timing but do not establish its factual justification. Sixth, the cleared views show Ellison down and then handcuffed without revealing what happened inside the obstruction.

No finding states that Ellison struck Rusk, reached for his belt, or posed an immediate threat. No finding states that she merely recoiled, never made contact, or presented no danger. Those propositions come from competing testimony and may be assumed or resolved only under the governing legal process.

The preparer certifies that the annotated descriptions use the complete certified fictional working copies, disclose the visibility criteria, and add no generated imagery. The analysis is reproducible by reviewing the stated times and geometry. It does not purport to authenticate the source files; Sergeant Lila Grant’s separate declaration addresses export custody.

This document was created for an invented case and filed on its simulated docket on December 12, 2025. It is neither a real forensic report nor advice about interpreting any actual body-camera recording.